

LETTER FROM HENRY
DUFFIELD TO HIS BROTHER
BETHUNE DUFFIELD IN MICHIGAN

Head Quarters 9th Reg^t M^y
Middletown December 13th 1861

My dear Shime

I received your letter containing
amount of my indebtedness and find it correct
as far as items are concerned but I did not
expect that you would advance for them all not-
do I wish you to do so for although it will
eventually be received by you still you will have
been for two months advancing some two hundred
or more dollars and it will not be until the
the first of March (owing to the way in which
we are paid) that I can all square with you
I understood rather that he was going to take up
some of the small debts and although I would
still have against me the same amount of
encumbrances it would be more easily earned
by my creditors if it was in some way a
little divided. Did you ^{father or mother} ask whether Phelps, Mudgett
and Town & Sheldon's Bill, had been paid? I will be
paid on January 1st ~~the~~ between 2⁰⁰ & 260 dollars but
my mess bill and the necessary money to have with
me will bring it down to less than \$240. I am
afraid. My pay is \$136.50 per month making from
the 1st of Nov^r to the 1st of January due me from
the 1st of Nov^r \$278.00 outside of this there is due me from
some body either the State of United States pay for six
days at 455 per day amounting to 2785 if I could get

that at the next payment and the Paymaster said
he had no doubt I would there would be due me

For pay from Nov: 1st to Jan: 1st 1900 278.21

For pay " Sept: 10 to 16th 27.86

Total 306.07

Deduct Thomas wages 26.00

" Mess Bill about 16.00

" Personal monies 20.00

Amount Remaining 244.07

If however I do not receive pay for the time between 27.86

Sept: 10 & 16 I will have but 226.21

this leaving me in your debt 43.54

I still have between ten and fifteen dollars of what you
gave me when I started and I do not think I shall
need to retain more than 15.00 or 20.00 dollars for my
own use. The only reason I have used up so much of
this is because as I settled down into camp life I found
out many little things would tend to my comfort which
I had not thought of before. I am sorry that you took up
all these debts as it is. I suppose a pretty hard time
for money and may give you trouble. The Mess Bill
from some cause or other has been ~~excessively~~ ^{excessively} high. ^{costing}
from the 2nd of ^{October} ~~September~~ to the 24th of November \$50.50 or in
other words \$12.50 a week a pretty high price for board!

We have had a new arrival of another regiment which
has just arrived on the other side of Salt River but whether
they will remain here or go on to Elizabethtown I do not
know. One thing I do know however that we are going to

id
me
have a big fight down here in Kentucky seventeen Reg^{ts}
passed through Louisville day before yesterday for down
South and four Reg^{ts} passed through here making
21,000 mi all moving Southward as fast as possible
two more have passed here yesterday and day before
yesterday. In fact every soldier that Bull can command
he is pushing down and will probably make a
simultaneous attack ~~with~~ with Mc Clellan. I hope
he will succeed but our men are mostly sick or
heavily convalescent and I am a little afraid we
may get whipped. If we do the "gallant ninth" will
have a chance to distinguish themselves. We have a
strong position and our men are cool and steady
and will fight like heroes. I feel confident of that.
So you may expect that you will have cause
to rejoice in having two brothers in the 9th. If
you seen Mills or my description of our Fort you
will see not only that it is very strong but also
that it has another very important advantage
namely that once in the Fort we must stay there
we can have no Bull Run here for the simple
reason that there is no opportunity for it. On one
side the enemy and on the other a precipice.
Then again our boys are just the men for the
place. They are cool and steady and although
I do not think they will ~~ever~~ do anything very
dashing or brilliant they will stay like Bull dogs.
If they ever have the opportunity they will show

H. M. Duffield
Dec 18/61

Their faces cool and determined, and so great is their confidence in their Colonel, we can hold them up to anything they will stand by him to the death. This is not mere "bragg". I saw it the night we first turned out at the long roll. They came out silently and quietly, while an Ohio Regiment was kicking a big enough rumpus for a whole army of rebels. I must close this in order to make out my report in time for the mail. I sincerely congratulate you on your new accession to the family. Give my respects to Mrs. Lathrop, Elisha and any of my friends who may enquire after me, and believe me

Your affectionate brother
Henry M. Duffield.

My Dear Thome

Your letters are received requesting to know what our sick folks need. I can safely answer that we are liberally supplied with everything we need, more that the kindness of the Military Board have given us the requisite stimulants we so much need. The ladies of our own state as well as the state of Ohio and Indiana have been very liberal also, and we are here in best late condition. Now that the Surgeon or doctor has returned we do not need the service of an assistant Surgeon as I have picked into the service Dr. Georgeagan a physician familiar with the disease of this locality and we have been steadily improving since he began. We are gaining rapidly in both health strength and spirit. I am quite encouraged once more. Our move upon the hill has been of great service to us. The absence of malaria incident to this high ground has checked the typhoid and by the first of January we will I am confident be all right. The men withdraw daily although we have buried thirty of our men before in Kentucky. I will try and get you a pass from that point although I cannot promise to succeed in the operation as I understand all passes to citizens are strictly prohibited. Yours in great haste H. M.